

ENGLISH LANGUAGE

MODERN ENGLISH (891)

PAPER 1 (Theory)

Maximum Marks: 80

Time Allowed: Three Hours

Reading Time: Additional Fifteen Minutes

Instructions to Candidates

1. You are allowed an additional **fifteen minutes** for **only** reading the question paper.
2. You must **NOT** start writing during reading time.
3. This question paper has 5 printed pages.
4. It has **four** questions in all.
5. Answer **all** questions.
6. You are advised to spend not more than 45 minutes on Question 1, 55 minutes on Question 2, 30 minutes on Question 3 and 50 minutes on Question 4.
7. While answering Multiple Choice Questions in Question 4, you are required to write only **one** option as the answer.
8. You should begin each answer on a fresh page.
9. The intended marks for questions are given in brackets [].

Instruction to Supervising Examiner

1. Kindly read aloud the Instructions given on page 1 to all the candidates present in the examination hall.

Question 1

Write a composition (in approximately 400 – 450 words) on any **one** of the following subjects.

(You are reminded that you will be rewarded for the orderly and coherent presentation of [20] the matter, use of appropriate style and general accuracy of spelling, punctuation and grammar.)

- (i) One sultry summer night, the electricity in your neighbourhood failed for several hours. Describe what people did, the sights, sounds and smells of the neighbourhood in the dark, and the moment the lights returned. Describe how you felt at the end of the night.
- (ii) You taught an elderly neighbour to use a smartphone for making digital payments. Narrate the challenges you faced and how the experience changed your view of the elderly.
- (iii) Social media has made young people lonelier. Argue either FOR or AGAINST the given statement.
- (iv) Silence.
- (v) Failure is the stepping stone to success. Present your reflections on this statement.
- (vi) Write an original short story that begins with the words: ‘The phone rang at midnight, and I knew at once that...’

Question 2

- (i) You are a staff reporter for a local daily. A fire broke out in a crowded market in your town last evening. Write a report for your newspaper in about 250 – 300 words, based on the following guidelines: [15]
- date, time and place of the fire – its suspected cause – the extent of the damage – rescue efforts by the fire brigade and local people – accounts of eyewitnesses – steps promised by the authorities
- (ii) As a member of the Social Service Club of your school, you wish to organise a blood donation camp in the school in collaboration with a local hospital. Write a proposal in not more than 150 words, stating the steps you would take to make it a success. [10]

Question 3

Answer subparts (i), (ii) and (iii).

- (i) Rewrite the following sentences according to the instructions given after each of them in brackets. Make other changes that may be necessary, but do not change the meaning of each sentence. [5]
- (a) As soon as the curtain rose, the audience fell silent.
(Begin: Hardly ...)
- (b) Do not leave the gate open after dark.
(Begin: Let ...)
- (c) The coach said to the players, “Drink plenty of water before the match.”
(Begin: The coach advised ...)
- (d) Meera sings beautifully as well as plays the sitar.
(Begin: Not only ...)
- (e) Arjun had no idea that the letter would change his life.
(Begin: Little ...)
- (ii) Replace the INCORRECT underlined words to make the following sentences meaningful and grammatically correct. Do not copy the sentences. [5]
- (a) The notice on the lawn asked visitors to keep out the grass.
- (b) Rohan reads the newspaper every morning to keep up to current affairs.
- (c) We set up for the hills at dawn to avoid the traffic.
- (d) The alumni association has set off a scholarship fund for needy students.
- (e) When the manager offered her a chance to work abroad, she jumped over it.
- (f) Do not jump at conclusions before you have heard both sides of the story.
- (g) The accountant went off the bills carefully before signing them.
- (h) Despite the interruption, the speaker went on to his lecture as though nothing had happened.
- (i) The final match was called out because of the heavy rain.
- (j) The situation called on quick thinking, and the captain acted at once.

- (iii) Fill in the blanks in the passage given below with the appropriate form of the verb given in brackets. Do not write the passage but write the verbs in the correct order. [5]

Last month my father _____ (1) (buy) a new television, and Grandfather at once _____ (2) (refuse) to touch its remote control. It had forty buttons, and he _____ (3) (declare) that no honest machine needed more than four. For a week he sat in front of the blank screen every evening, _____ (4) (wait) for someone to switch it on for him.

Then, one Sunday, while the rest of us _____ (5) (sleep), he decided to conquer it. We woke to the sound of a cricket commentary _____ (6) (blare) at full volume in a language that none of us _____ (7) (hear) before. Grandfather was standing in the middle of the room in his pyjamas, pressing buttons at random.

“Do not laugh,” he said sternly, when he saw our faces. “This machine _____ (8) (understand) only one language, and I intend to _____ (9) (learn) it.”

By lunchtime he could change channels faster than any of us, and since that day nobody else _____ (10) (allow) to hold the remote, not even my father.

Question 4

Read the passage given below and answer the questions (i), (ii) and (iii) that follow.

(1) It is almost midnight on a beach near the mouth of the Rushikulya river in Odisha, and Dr Meenakshi Rao has not switched on her torch for three hours. She will not switch it on tonight at all. Around her a team of eleven volunteers waits in the dark, and every one of them is watching the sea.

(2) They are waiting for olive ridley turtles. Every winter thousands of female olive ridleys arrive at a handful of beaches on this coast within a few nights of one another and climb out of the water to lay their eggs. Scientists use the Spanish word *arribada* for this mass nesting; it simply means “arrival”. Tonight, if the team is lucky, the arrival will begin. 5

(3) Dr Rao explains, in a whisper, why the torches stay off. A nesting turtle that is disturbed by bright light may abandon her nest and return to the sea without laying. Worse, the hatchlings that emerge from the sand some seven weeks later find the sea by moving towards the brightest horizon, which on a natural beach is the moonlit water. A single floodlit hotel can lead thousands of them inland, where they die of exhaustion or are eaten by dogs. 10 15

(4) At a quarter past twelve, a volunteer at the northern end of the beach raises a red lamp twice. A turtle is out of the water. The team moves towards her slowly, keeping low and well behind her, because she is most easily frightened in her first minutes on land. She is about seventy centimetres long, grey-green and glistening, and she hauls herself up the slope with a steady, laborious rhythm, stopping every few metres as if to catch her breath. 20

(5) Above the high-tide line she stops and begins to dig, using her rear flippers like a pair of scoops. It takes her nearly an hour to shape a flask-shaped pit about forty-five centimetres deep. Only when she begins to lay, dropping her soft white eggs one or two at a time, does Dr Rao signal that the team may come closer. A laying turtle seems to fall into a kind of trance, and for the next twenty minutes she will ignore almost anything. 25

(6) The work is quick and careful. One volunteer counts the eggs in a low voice as they fall. Another measures the length and width of the shell with a flexible tape. Dr Rao kneels beside a front flipper, checks it for an old tag, and, finding none, fixes a small numbered metal tag to its edge with a pair of pliers. The number, the measurements and the exact position of the nest are written on a waterproof sheet by the light of a dim red lamp. 30

(7) When she has laid one hundred and twelve eggs, the turtle covers the pit, pressing the sand down with surprising force, and then flings more sand over it with her front flippers to disguise the spot. Then she turns, without hurry, and makes her way back to the sea. Dr Rao watches her until the first wave lifts her away. 35

(8) Tagging tells the team where these turtles travel and how often they return. Turtles tagged on this coast have been found, years later, hundreds of kilometres away; others come back to the same stretch of sand season after season. “Every returning tag is a letter from the ocean,” Dr Rao says. “It tells us that this turtle survived the fishing nets and the plastic for one more year.” 40

(9) Those dangers are real. Many olive ridleys drown each year in trawling nets, which is why fishing is restricted near the nesting beaches during the season. Plastic bags, which turtles can mistake for jellyfish, claim many others. 45

(10) Yet Dr Rao is not gloomy. She points to the villages behind the beach, where young people who once collected turtle eggs to sell now guard the nests at night. When the hatchlings emerge, it is these same young people who make sure that the lights of the village are switched off. 50

(11) By four in the morning, the team has recorded thirty-seven nesting turtles. The sky over the sea is turning pale. Dr Rao stretches, finally switches on her torch, points it carefully at her own feet, and walks back up the beach. In fifty days she will be here again, to watch the smallest of these travellers make what she calls the most dangerous hundred metres in the world. 55

(Adapted from: A Night with the Arribada, an original feature written for this sample paper; the researcher is a composite)

(i)(a) Find a single word from the passage that will exactly replace the underlined word or words in the following sentences. [3]

- (1) When the storm grew worse, the crew had to leave behind the damaged ship and row to the shore.
- (2) Copying the entire register by hand was a slow and tiring task.
- (3) The grass, still wet with dew, was shining with moisture in the morning sun.

- (b) For each of the words given below, choose the correct sentence that uses the same word unchanged in spelling, but with a different meaning from that which it carries in the passage. [3]
- (1) **tag** (line 30)
- (A) The price tag was still attached to the new shirt.
 - (B) She tagged all her friends in the photograph.
 - (C) Each suitcase carried a luggage tag with the owner's address.
 - (D) The children played tag in the park until it grew dark.
- (2) **spot** (line 36)
- (A) There was a spot of ink on the collar of his shirt.
 - (B) We found a quiet spot by the river for our picnic.
 - (C) The guard spotted the intruder at once.
 - (D) This is the spot where the old temple once stood.
- (3) **season** (line 41)
- (A) The monsoon season usually begins in June.
 - (B) The cook asked us to season the soup with salt and pepper.
 - (C) He is a seasoned traveller who has visited forty countries.
 - (D) The cricket season ended earlier than expected this year.
- (ii) Answer the following questions as briefly as possible in your own words.
- (a) Why does Dr Rao refuse to switch on her torch while the turtles are nesting? [2]
 - (b) Why do you think Dr Rao calls a returning tag 'a letter from the ocean'? [2]
 - (c) Briefly discuss any two themes of the passage. [2]
- (iii) Summarise what the turtle does and how the team records her, from the moment she comes ashore until she returns to the sea (paragraphs 4 to 7). You are required to write the summary in the **grid form** in about 100 words. The use of abbreviations and contractions will not be accepted. Failure to keep within the word limit will be penalised. [8]

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